considerably aiding in population control.

To promote entrepreneurship among women, the government launched the "Mukhyamantri Mahila Udyami Yojana" providing financial assistance up to Rs.10 lakh, of which Rs.5 lakh is a grant and the remaining Rs.5 lakh is an interest-free loan repayable over seven years. The "Hunar" programme offers vocational training to women from minority groups in 20 different trades, along with tool-kits to start their businesses under the "Auzar" scheme.

Bihar government's ambitious project 'Jeevika' has made remarkable strides in women's empowerment, with over 10.47 lakh self-help groups established to date. These groups have mobilized more than 1.30 crore women, who have become Jeevika Didis, driving positive change in their communities, and becoming self-sufficient in the process.

Jeevika's impactful self-help group model is now being replicated in urban areas, where women will come together to form supportive communities. This expansion marks a significant milestone in Jeevika's journey, as it continues to break down geographical barriers and empower women across the state.



INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT: BUILDING THE BACKBONE OF PROGRESS

Infrastructure development has been a cornerstone of the Nitish Kumar government, with a focus on improving road connectivity and transportation. Under his leadership, Bihar has seen substantial improvements in road infrastructure and electrification, contributing to better connectivity and easier movement of people and goods.

Since 2005, Bihar has seen a transformative expansion in its road network. The government has laid down extensive road infrastructure, connecting even the most remote villages to urban centres. This connectivity has facilitated not only the movement of people but also boosted economic activities by making markets more accessible to rural farmers and artisans.

The state government has upgraded all state highways to at least two-lane roads with paved shoulders and improved major district roads. Significant investments have been made in constructing new bridges and flyovers over major rivers like the Ganga, Kosi, Gandak, and Sone to ensure seamless transportation across the state. Key projects include the construction of a 6-lane cable-stayed bridge between Kacchi Dargah and Bidupur, a 4-lane bridge between Bakhtiyarpur and Tajpur, 20.5 Km long J.P. Ganga Path and a parallel 6-lane bridge to the existing Vikramshila Setu. These projects are part of a broader vision to ensure that no part of Bihar is more than five hours away from the state capital, Patna.

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GOOD PRACTICES AND SOCIAL WELFARE: INCREASING HAPPINESS QUOTIENT

The Nitish Kumar government has implemented several governance reforms aimed at improving

